

Leo Zhang

Dear Plant & Food Research Hiring Manager,

Intermediate software engineer with 10+ years delivering scalable backend systems, microservices, and APIs using Java, Spring Cloud, and Agile practices. Experienced in enterprise backends for manufacturing and messaging with practical focus on uptime, latency, and release rhythm. Proven delivery includes long-lived services with REST APIs, observability, cloud deployment on AWS, and direct customer engagement for requirements analysis and technical guidance. Additional expertise includes CI/CD, database performance tuning (MySQL, Redis, SQL Server), and cross-team API contracts. Master's in Computer and Information Sciences from Auckland University of Technology, First Class Honours.

I am drawn to the Software Developer - Data and Digital role because it demands the kind of work I do best. What sets me apart is that I bring full-stack awareness to backend delivery — I've built APIs that mobile and frontend teams actually enjoy consuming, and I design data contracts before writing implementation code. That comes from 10+ years working across layers. I see the emphasis on breeding and kiwifruit in your JD, which maps directly to experience I can apply immediately.

I am drawn to Plant & Food Research because it focuses on building practical technology that delivers real value. The work your team is doing in this space is exactly the kind of challenge I want to invest my next chapter in — building something that matters, with people who set high standards.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how my experience can contribute to Plant & Food Research's engineering team. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Kind regards,

Leo Zhang